

ing them will reveal the entire item in the bottom part. To visit the Web site, the link is presented in the header. TB allows tagging the news items—which is a feature available for other services like e-mail as well.

Thunderbird is a very basic feed reader that can be of use to those who already use it for e-mail or newsgroups.

7.2.4 Online Feed Readers

There are many online sites that allow a user to view feeds from multiple sources. In many cases getting registered on the site allows the feeds to be customised. A long list of online Feed readers is available at <http://www.newsonfeeds.com/faq/aggregators> and is worth a look. Grabline.com, which is mentioned in that list, is of particular interest for Indians, since it brings together feeds from the major news papers like Indian Express, Times of India, Hindu, Telegraph, etc., besides a few other Indian Web sites. The number of irrelevant stuff on the page could be distracting though.

Google Reader

This is the feed reader offered by Google. By extensively using AJAX the interface is made extremely responsive and intuitive. You need to create an account at google.com to avail of the services. Once signed in, accessing google.com/reader launches the service. Google recommends a few feeds which you can ignore. The Add subscription link allows you to search for feeds matching terms. To subscribe to any of the feeds in the search results just click on the Subscribe link. The news items in the feed are displayed by selecting the feed name in the left panel. The interface allows changing the display properties, and sort order. Clicking on any of the news item links causes the Web site to be loaded in a different browser window/tab. The interface allows other options like e-mailing the news item or link, tagging the news item for easy retrieval, etc.

The experience of using the reader service is a pleasant one. The biggest drawback of online feed readers, which also includes Google's service, is the inability to view the news items offline.